

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - August 4, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, August 4, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio Alla Vostra case-study page after the August 3 UI Foundations / UX Product Flow pass, keeping the website local-only at <http://127.0.0.1:3000>, tightening the one-row reveal behavior, refining Iconography & Imagery ordering and square-frame treatment, preserving the Original Hero background and cheeseboard alignment, adding the Close sticky-icon sample, installing Playwright for browser verification without running concurrent AVDs, capturing real Alla Vostra app navigation and control assets, replacing the Navigations and Controls & Inputs placeholder imagery with real PNG crops, validating the local route and TypeScript build, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, reviewing all prior Portfolio PDF worklogs, and generating the August 4 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after `portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf` and the August 3 documentation state. The committed source state reviewed for this record is `529bd9808ae9e4e9d50c45f812e9f8f408ad4597` on main, matching origin/main before this PDF was first generated. The local Alla Vostra application repository was used only as a style and capture reference during the real-control-asset pass; temporary capture scaffolding was removed, leaving no committed Alla Vostra application source changes for this record. Cinerific, Credit King, Figma, App Store, Google Play, and public Hostinger deployment branches were not modified for this record.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Ran `./read_project.sh` from `/Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio` and regenerated `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` before writing this worklog, preserving the project convention that Codex refreshes the current source snapshot before continuing Portfolio documentation work.
- Reviewed the refreshed `portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`, including project notes, current source tree, line-numbered source dumps, public image and font inventories, PDF inventory, package and deployment configuration, git context, and the standing instruction to ask for a commit message before committing or pushing.
- Reviewed every pre-existing Portfolio root-level worklog PDF: `portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july14.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july15_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july16.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july19.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july20.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july21.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july22.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july23.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july24.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july25.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july29.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july30.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_july31.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part1.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part2.pdf`, `portfolio_worklog_august1_part3.pdf`, and `portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf`.
- Extracted text from all nineteen existing Portfolio PDFs with `pdftotext` and checked metadata/page counts with `pdftinfo` to preserve title cadence, opening-summary density, section order, compact bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched lists, follow-up context, output-artifact close, root-level filename style, letter-size pages, PDF 1.4 output, Codex author/creator/producer metadata, and Helvetica-style base-font convention.

- Used portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf as the closest structural baseline because it documented the UI Foundations / UX Product Flow split, DOM-based flow chart, custom category system, imported Alla Vostra app fonts and assets, local validation language, and manual-deploy context.
- Kept the August 1 multi-part worklogs in view as the nearest visual-system references for device-frame, hero-composition, local-preview, and static-export wording, while keeping July 30 and July 31 in view for compact daily and follow-up PDF structure.
- Reviewed git history and source state through git log, git show --stat, git show --name-status, git diff --stat, current branch state, and the committed scope for 529bd98. HEAD and origin/main both resolved to 529bd98 before this PDF was first generated.
- Reviewed app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx, app/projects/alla-vostra/ExpandableFlowStacks.tsx, app/projects/alla-vostra/page.tsx, app/globals.css, .gitignore, package.json, package-lock.json, next-env.d.ts, read_project.sh, and the new public/images/alla-vostra/ui-assets PNG inventory.
- Reviewed selected Alla Vostra application source and live-rendered styling as references only while capturing controls, including app header, shop overlay, button shadow, sticky icon, cart, product-tab, quantity-counter, and checkout-control treatments.

Baseline Status Before August 4 Work

- The August 3 Portfolio work had already established the Alla Vostra UI Foundations / UX Product Flow switcher, moved the startup screenshot into UI Foundations, rebuilt the UX flow diagram as a DOM layout, and filled Colors & Theming, Typography & Spacing, and Iconography & Imagery with app-grounded samples.
- Navigations, Controls & Inputs, and Visual Hierarchy still contained placeholder-heavy or incomplete presentation paths after August 3, leaving future work to replace generic sample stacks with real Alla Vostra interface assets.
- The reveal behavior still needed refinement so every UI Foundations and UX Product Flow section initially showed only one row of image/device-frame stacks, then exposed overflow assets only after Show More was clicked.
- The Show More / Show Less button row needed stable positioning during state transfer so the button did not jump when the label changed or when hidden stacks became visible.
- Iconography & Imagery was still under active ordering and sizing iteration. Original Hero, Original Art, Original Photography, and Original Icons needed stack swaps, square-frame consistency, and final one-row/narrow-layout behavior.
- The Original Hero sample had previously used Small and Android Large variants. The user wanted only one square Hero frame, scaled to match the combined width of a two-square stack row, without disturbing the original header-background and cheeseboard asset positioning.
- Original Photography still carried gray product captions and an Original Photography header above Product #3 in some wide two-column modes, even after the user wanted the image/text stack preserved while removing that extra heading.
- The Original Icons category had Shopping Cart and Tutorial samples but did not yet include the app-correct Close button sample from the Alla Vostra interaction language.
- The user rejected CSS-drawn button approximations for Navigations and Controls & Inputs and asked for honest real-life imagery of the actual app buttons and nav controls.
- Playwright was not yet installed in the Portfolio project. The user preferred installing Playwright locally over running two Android Virtual Devices concurrently for visual capture and verification.

Goals for August 4

- Keep the Portfolio site running locally only at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> during this work cycle.
- Study existing snapshots and worklogs before continuing, then maintain the established Portfolio layout, naming, validation, and documentation conventions.
- Make every UI Foundations and UX Product Flow section display only one row of image/device-frame assets before Show More, even when additional sibling assets exist below the fold.
- Preserve Show More / Show Less button placement during expansion and collapse, avoiding layout jumps caused by label width or expanded-state transfer.
- Refine Iconography & Imagery ordering and content: swap Original Hero, Original Art, and Original Photography placement as requested; remove product captions; preserve Product #3 image placement; and add the Close icon sample.
- Convert Original Hero into one square Hero frame whose size matches the two-square stack width in the relevant layouts, while protecting the existing background PNG and cheeseboard PNG visual positions.
- Install Playwright as a project dependency, update ignore rules for generated Playwright artifacts, and use it for truthful browser-based verification.
- Capture real Alla Vostra app controls and replace the Navigations and Controls & Inputs sections with image-backed square frames rather than CSS-drawn button replicas.
- Validate TypeScript, local route health, loaded UI asset imagery, and diff whitespace before generating the next dated Portfolio worklog PDF.

Work Completed - Local Preview, Snapshot, and Reveal Behavior

- Ran the project read script at the start of the working sequence and reviewed the existing snapshot and worklog cadence before changing the Alla Vostra page presentation.
- Kept the Portfolio dev workflow local at <http://127.0.0.1:3000> and restarted or cleared the local development cache when stale UI state or requested cache clearing made it necessary.
- Updated the shared reveal logic so narrow layouts use a max-width driven flow query rather than the previous portrait-only query, matching the user request for one visible section column when only one column can appear at a time.
- Adjusted UI Foundations and UX Product Flow section rendering so collapsed states show only the first row of assets per section, with additional stacks held behind the Show More interaction.
- Added an expanded-visible rendering path for assets that needed to exist below the initially visible row without changing the collapsed row count or disturbing the already-visible sibling stacks.
- Fixed the Show More / Show Less control width for the Alla Vostra case page so the button position remains visually stable when the expanded state changes.
- Preserved the existing category/stage headings, green eyebrows, and square-frame sizing model while limiting the actual behavior change to the requested reveal mechanics.

Work Completed - Iconography & Imagery Refinement

- Reordered Iconography & Imagery so Original Hero, Original Photography, Original Art, and Original Icons landed in the requested sequence after the user-directed stack swaps.
- Removed the Small Original Hero device frame and renamed the remaining sample to Hero, then converted it from an Android Large/tall frame into a square-shaped frame consistent with the surrounding UI Foundation samples.

- Scaled the Hero square frame so its width matches the combined width of a two-square row where applicable, including the later portrait-mode request to let Hero fill the equivalent full width in single-column modes.
- Restored the exact accepted Original Hero background and cheeseboard appearance after an intermediate adjustment moved those source assets instead of only changing the frame shape and scale.
- Swapped Original Hero with Original Art, then moved Original Art relative to the Product #3 photography stack per the user-directed ordering changes.
- Removed the Original Photography header above Product #3 in the wide two-column section-asset mode without moving the Product #3 text/image placement stack that the user wanted protected.
- Removed the gray caption text from Products #1 through #3, preserved the green labels and image vertical positions, and placed Product #3 into the first-row grouping centered between Product #1 and Product #2.
- Added the Close sticky icon sample into Original Icons using the Alla Vostra close-button visual language, then positioned and reordered Shopping Cart, Tutorial, and Close as requested.

Work Completed - Real Navigation and Control Assets

- Installed @playwright/test as a Portfolio dev dependency so visual inspection and capture could happen inside the local project without requiring two concurrent Android emulator sessions.
- Added Playwright output folders to .gitignore so test-results, playwright-report, and blob-report artifacts do not pollute future source changes.
- Used Playwright against a temporary local Alla Vostra app web capture route to inspect and crop actual controls from the rendered React Native styling instead of recreating buttons by approximation in CSS.
- Captured fifteen real Alla Vostra control/nav PNGs into public/images/alla-vostra/ui-assets: header-shop.png, shop-preview.png, overlay-nav-left.png, overlay-nav-right.png, overlay-center-products.png, overlay-center-cart.png, product-tab-active.png, product-tab-inactive.png, product-image-prev.png, product-image-next.png, product-add.png, cart-counter.png, cart-remove.png, cart-add-items.png, and cart-checkout.png.
- Removed stale rough-capture assets from the UI asset directory so only the real captured set remains available for the Portfolio sections.
- Replaced the Navigations section with image-backed samples for SHOP, Shop, overlay previous/next controls, Products, Cart, active/inactive product tabs, and product-image chevrons.
- Replaced the Controls & Inputs section with image-backed samples for ADD, quantity counter, remove, Add items, and Checkout.
- Removed the old CSS-drawn ActionButtonAsset renderer and quantity-triangle stand-ins from ProductFlowSwitcher so these sections now depend on the captured app imagery.
- Added square-frame CSS for the real action assets, centering the contained PNGs while preserving the existing UI Foundations swatch/device-frame structure and responsive grid behavior.
- Stopped the temporary Alla Vostra capture server after generating the assets and reverted capture-only changes in the Alla Vostra application repo so the Portfolio commit retained the new PNGs without leaving external app scaffolding behind.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed with tsc --noEmit after the real-control-asset implementation and again during this August 4 worklog-generation pass.
- curl -I http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra returned HTTP 200 from the local Next.js dev server during the final documentation pass.
- A Playwright browser pass loaded http://127.0.0.1:3000/projects/alla-vostra, switched to UI Foundations, scrolled through the page, and confirmed 15 ui-assets images were present with unloadedCount: 0.
- git diff --check passed after normalizing trailing whitespace inside the regenerated snapshot text file.
- The generated Portfolio dev server remained local-only for this work cycle; no Hostinger deploy or public static-export branch update was performed as part of this record.
- The temporary Expo web capture server used for Alla Vostra asset extraction was stopped after the PNGs were produced.
- The Alla Vostra application repo showed no remaining diff in the temporarily touched capture files after cleanup; unrelated pre-existing snapshot artifacts in that sibling repo were left alone.
- The new PDF was generated with the same standard-library PDF writer pattern, letter page size, Helvetica-style font usage, Codex metadata, and root-level Portfolio filename convention as the mature prior worklogs.

Files Touched During August 4 Portfolio Work

- app/projects/alla-vostra/ProductFlowSwitcher.tsx - refined UI Foundations category ordering, Original Hero square-frame rendering, Original Art/Photography layout behavior, Original Icons Close sample, Navigations asset data, Controls & Inputs asset data, and image-backed action-asset rendering.
- app/projects/alla-vostra/ExpandableFlowStacks.tsx - updated collapsed-stack logic from portrait-only behavior to the shared narrow-layout behavior used by the one-row reveal rule.
- app/globals.css - added and tuned square-grid behavior, Hero composition sizing, sticky Close icon styling, action-asset square frames, stable Alla Vostra Show More button width, and responsive narrow-layout frame constraints.
- public/images/alla-vostra/ui-assets/*.png - added the real captured Alla Vostra navigation and control assets used by the Navigations and Controls & Inputs categories.
- .gitignore - added Playwright generated-output folders.
- package.json and package-lock.json - added @playwright/test as a development dependency for local browser validation and capture work.
- next-env.d.ts - reflected the Next.js generated route-types path state produced during the local development and validation cycle.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated with ./read_project.sh for current project context and normalized after generation so diff whitespace checks pass.
- portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf - generated as this August 4 Portfolio worklog artifact in the root-level Portfolio worklog convention.

Follow-Up Context

- Navigations and Controls & Inputs are now image-backed with real app captures. Future changes to those controls should prefer fresh app captures or source-backed assets over CSS approximation so the Portfolio stays honest to the mobile product.

- Playwright is now available inside the Portfolio project for repeatable local page inspection, screenshot capture, and asset-load verification.
- The one-row collapsed reveal behavior is intentionally shared across UI Foundations and UX Product Flow sections. Future additions should account for the visible-row count instead of assuming all sibling stacks are visible before expansion.
- Original Hero uses layered background and cheeseboard assets rather than a full screenshot. Any future size changes should protect the current asset positions unless the user explicitly asks to move the imagery itself.
- The Close, Tutorial, and Shopping Cart icon samples remain static Portfolio recreations grounded in the Alla Vostra app source styling, while the action/nav controls are now raster captures from the app appearance.
- No public deployment was performed during this record. The active local preview remains the verified reference until the user requests deploy, publish, push, or Hostinger branch work.
- The refreshed snapshot and this August 4 PDF are local documentation artifacts until the user requests or approves a documentation commit.

Output Artifact

- Generated file: portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf.
- Location: /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf.
- Naming follows the existing root-level Portfolio convention for a single daily PDF: portfolio_worklog_august4.pdf.
- Uses the same daily worklog structure and compact technical voice established by portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_august3.pdf.
- Generated with a small standard-library PDF writer; no external PDF dependency was installed for this artifact.
- The local project date used for this filename and title is Tuesday, August 4, 2026 in the current Eastern-time project context.